

Opera

ERICK OH, Tonko House, USA



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PROJECT URL

<https://erickoh.com/opera>

DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

Opera is a massive 8K size animation installation project that portrays our society and history, which is filled with beauty and absurdity. This ambitious piece can be simply defined as a contemporary animated edition of the Renaissance fresco mural paintings. Driven by the spirits of Bosch, Michelangelo, Botticelli, and others, the animation enables viewers to experience a range of in-depth emotions through this epic reflection of human life: it is hopeful, funny, thoughtful,

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yet scary and sad. This piece is not only a living piece of art, but an invitation to question the mechanisms of your society and behavior.

I first came up with this core idea and message in the year of 2017, which was filled with so many iconic political moments in our recent human history around the world. In January 2017, Donald Trump became the president of the US and a few months later, in March, the president Park Geun-hye in Korea was impeached. It was, indeed, the year of chaos and I had to tell a story that documents this part of humanity which actually has been repeating in human history numerous times, in different forms and cultures. This piece touches upon diverse issues like racism, terrorism, religion, natural disasters, war, education, economy, and more in different parts of in our society. It may make you laugh, or it may make you sad or disturb you. But we all know that that's all part of our life and who we are. The ultimate message I'd love to share with everyone is to learn from our past and grow to make our today better than yesterday, and to make tomorrow brighter than today. I really hope this piece could touch everyone's heart and start the right discussion on the right topic.

ARTIST INFORMATION

Erick Oh is a Korean filmmaker/artist based in California, USA. His films have been introduced and awarded at numerous film festivals including the Academy Awards, Annie Awards, Annecy Animation Festival, Zagreb Film Festival, SIGGRAPH, Anima Mundi, and more. With his background in fine art at Seoul National University and film at UCLA, Erick became an animator at Pixar Animation Studios from 2010 to 2016. Erick then joined Tonko House with his fellow former Pixar artists and directed *PIG: The Dam Keeper Poems*, which won the Crystal Award at Annecy Animation Festival 2018. <http://erickoh.com>

